



Logging off

A list of places you can visit across the globe that offer plans to unplug. <http://dgit.in/TravelLogOff>



Using Technology Healthily

A document produced by NIMHANS with which you can assess whether your use of technology is healthy or not. <http://dgit.in/HealthTechServ>

missions in detail. A Facebook spokesperson stated that the Facebook Messenger permissions have not changed. So if a user has installed the Facebook or Facebook Messenger app in the past, he has agreed to give the app the same access that a person installing the app now would receive.

Facebook confirmed last week that the messenger app split has begun. The social networking site added that the switch to messenger will benefit users as it is faster and more reliable. The app already has more than 200 million



Facebook Messenger

monthly users and has seen a positive response.

However users who have not downloaded the app may see messages disappearing from the main Facebook app. This move will affect iPhone and Android app users. According to a Facebook spokesperson the changes will be rolled out over the coming weeks to all users.

Facebook acquires cyber security startup PrivateCore

Facebook has acquired California-based cyber security startup PrivateCore, in a move to improve defences of its vast server network. The finan-

cial terms of the deal were not announced.

PrivateCore was launched two years back in 2012 in Palo Alto and specializes in protecting servers against malware and other kinds of intrusions. The company raised \$2.25 million in funding in 2012 from Foundation Capital.

PrivateCore's Oded Horovitz stated in a blog post that the two firms "have an aligned mission."

"Since the beginning, we have worked tirelessly on our technology to protect servers from malware threats, unauthorized physical access, and malicious hardware devices," he said. Working together with Facebook, there is a huge opportunity to pursue our joint vision at scale with incredible impact."

Facebook's Joe Sullivan stated, "I believe that PrivateCore's technology and expertise will help support Facebook's mission to help make the world more open and connected, in a secure and trusted way. Over time, we plan to deploy PrivateCore's technology directly into the Facebook server stack."

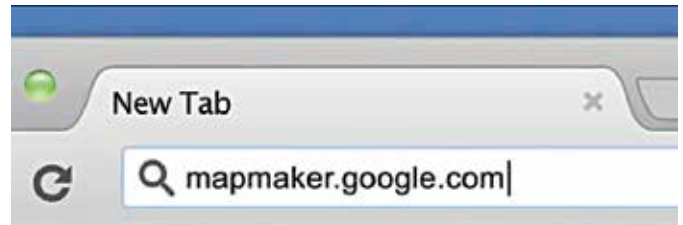
Google's Mapathon comes under scanner

Surveyor General of India Swarna Subba Rao slammed Google for allegedly gathering classified information through a mapping competition in February last year. Rao pointed out that Google had "polluted" the web with classified information in spite of being warned against doing so.

"During their (Google's) Mapathon 2013 exercise, they collected a lot of classified data and we had approached them to refrain from doing so when we came to know about it," Rao is quoted as saying. "They (Google) have expressed their

desire to meet me at some hotel but I have been firm of a meeting in office," he further said.

Rao's scathing attack on Google comes days after the CBI lodged a preliminary enquiry against the Internet company on the basis of a complaint filed by Surveyor General of India's



Google Mapathon

office to the Union Home Ministry. Google has been accused of not taking permission from the relevant authority before launching its Mapathon competition in 2013 in which users were asked to add their location details on Google Maps.

Surveyor General of India is the official mapping agency for the country. "The responsibility for producing, maintaining and disseminating the topographic map database of the whole country, which is the foundation of all spatial data vests with the Survey of India (SOI). Recently, SOI has been mandated to take a leadership role in liberalizing access of spatial data to user groups without jeopardizing national security," says the National Map Policy, 2005.

Can YouTube infect your computer?

A new report by Morgan Marquis-Boire says watching unencrypted YouTube videos and checking your Microsoft Live account can be used by hackers to infiltrate home computers.

According to a paper published by Morgan Marquis-Boire at the University of Toronto's Citizen Lab, spies

can use unencrypted YouTube streams and Microsoft Live log-ins by intercepting traffic and use them to inject malware in your PC. Hackers can easily view your e-mails, bank accounts, IMs and sensitive personal information with the malware.

"It's 'hacking on easy mode,'" explained a new report by Citizen Lab; "compromising a target becomes as simple as waiting for the user to view unencrypted content on the Internet." Network injection "allows for the 'tasking' of a specific target. Rather than performing a manual operation, a target can be entered into the system which will wait for them to browse to an appropriate website and then perform the required injection of malicious code into their traffic stream."

Marquis-Boire identifies two companies called 'Hacking Team' and 'FinFisher' that are known to sell law enforcement agencies "network-injection" technologies used for surveillance for around \$1 million dollars. Hacking Team uses the traffic from YouTube and Microsoft's login.live.com servers to install YouTube videos with surveillance software to track the target's activities online. The company works with governments like Morocco and the United Arab Emirates, but Marquis-Boire says similar technologies have been used by intelligence agencies in Britain, US, China, Russia and more. 